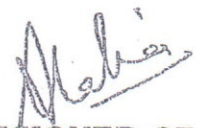


Subject:- Standing Order No.74-A regarding "Functioning of the Women Helpline Desk in CPR" -----

Enclosed please find herewith the Standing Order No.74-A - "Functioning of the Women Helpline Desk in CPR" issued vide No.56/P.Sec./Spl.C.P./Ops. dated 18.1.13 for strict compliance.


For SPL. COMMISSIONER OF POLICE,
OPERATIONS, DELHI

Encls : As above

No. ~~471-721~~ /Record Branch /PHQ dated Delhi the 24/1/2013.

Copy forwarded to:-

1. All Special Commissioners of Police including MD/DPHC, Delhi.
2. All Joint Commissioners of Police, Delhi
3. Additional Commissioners of Police, including P/PTC, Delhi.
4. All Deputy Commissioners of Police, District/Units, including FRRO, Delhi/ New Delhi.
5. SO to Commissioner of Police, LA to Commissioner of Police, Delhi
6. ACP/IT Centre with the direction to upload the Standing Order in Intra DP Net.
7. All ACsP Sub Division, Delhi including all ACsP in PHQ, Delhi.
8. All SHOs/Delhi Police through their respective DCsP with the direction to place the Standing Order in register No. 3 Part-I of the Police Stations.
9. All Inspectors/PHQ, including Reader to CP, Delhi.
10. Librarian/PHQ.

STANDING ORDER 74A

FUNCTIONING OF THE WOMEN HELPLINE DESK IN CPR

INTRODUCTION:

The National Capital Territory of Delhi is one of the most rapidly growing cities in the world where crime including violence against women and girls in public spaces, has emerged as a major challenge. While Delhi has been a leader in many urban innovations the problem of safety to women, especially in its streets, squares, parks, public transport system and other public places needs improvement on a regular basis. This lack of safety for women/girls, as perceived by them, significantly undermines their 'Right to the City' – the right to move around freely; to use and access public places and services; to make choices about their places of residence, work or leisure; and more importantly, to make the best of the opportunities the city has to offer. More specifically, school and college students and women workers, working in the organized as well as unorganized sectors need special attention. Women and girls sometimes face sexual harassment while using public transport facilities and while waiting for them at road sides, bus stops, Metro Stations etc. This fact is confirmed by the numerous calls being received by Women Helpline Numbers 1091, 1291, 23317004, 23490130 which are functional round the clock.

FUNCTIONING OF WOMEN HELPLINE NUMBERS:

(A) RECEIPT/MONITORING OF DISTRESS CALL

1. The Women Helpline shall be functional round-the-clock at Central Police Control Room.
2. The calls will be handled by lady police officers only.
3. Depending on the facts/details of the incident where police intervention is required, they shall direct the PCR van, inform the concerned District Control Room and the CAW Cell for appropriate action. They will also check the action taken by the police station and the CAW Cell and record the same. They shall also provide preliminary advice and counsel the caller to the best of their ability.
4. The telephone numbers of NGOs dealing with issues including legal assistance relating to women will also be kept readily available at the Helpline and would be provided to the caller, whenever needed and/or asked for.

5. The record of the information received and action taken will be kept in the following format, preferably in electronic form:

<u>Sl.No.</u>	<u>Name of PS/Distt.</u>	<u>Name and Address of the Complainant</u>
1	2	3
<u>Channel No. & Name of Operator</u>	<u>Date & Time of Receipt of call</u>	
4	5	
<u>Details of Complaint</u>	<u>Caller's Phone No.</u>	<u>DD Entry of Information</u>
6	7	8
<u>passed to CAW Cell</u>	<u>Time and date of PCR Van</u>	<u>Harat report DD</u>
9	10	
<u>No. & Time</u>	<u>Date of PS with remarks (if any)</u>	
	11	

(B) GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS FOR OPERATORS:

- i) Operator shall at all times be extremely polite and give a patient hearing to the caller.
- ii) The helpline operator should reassure the caller that help is on its way.
- iii) The operator shall not insist on the caller disclosing his/her identity, unless the caller so agrees and should assure the caller that the confidentiality of his/her identity and contact information shall be maintained.
- iv) A confidential record will be maintained in the format: - Identity of the caller, address, contact number, if disclosed, information related to PS/Distt., name of the officer to whom information was passed on with date and time.
- v) Information received should be passed on by telephone to the concerned SHO/ACP/DCP.

(C) DUTY OF THE OPERATOR:

1. Only Women Operators shall be deployed to handle calls received at these Help-line numbers.
2. The operator should be carefully selected who has good communication skills and has a good command over Hindi as well as the English language.

3. The operator shall behave cordially while dealing with the caller and shall respond promptly and effectively.
4. The operator should be familiar with the layout/topography of Delhi and NCR as well as of the jurisdictions of police stations concerned.
5. The caller shall be given a patient hearing.
6. The grievance of the caller shall be listened to carefully and noted down in the words of the caller.
7. If the operator faces any difficulty regarding language or any other, he/she will immediately transfer the call to the senior officer present on duty at Control Room at that time.
8. If the car or vehicle used in the incident moves to adjoining districts, Hotline, traffic, auto match etc. must be used for prompt response and establishing identity of the offending vehicle.
9. SHO/ACP/DCP/Jt. CP (Range)/Spl. CP (L&O)/CP shall be informed of the incident and mark the place of incident on the GPS map.
10. If fire-arm has been used, DCP/Crime & Jt. CP/Crime should be informed of the incident through message/voice. (Automatic SMS/Tetra).
11. DCP/Addl. CP/Distt./Jt. CP(Range)/Spl. CPL&O/Spl. CP Ops/C.P. Operator shall be informed of the incidents through messages/voice (Automatic SMS/Tetra).
12. The complete situation report shall be recorded before closing the incident/call.
13. If additional documentation is needed then the operator will put his/her remarks and the call will be escalated to the supervisor on duty for monitoring.
14. The Operator would close an incident from his/her task list once the entire follow up action has been taken.

(D) S.O.P. FOR RESPONSE TO THE DISTRESS CALL:

1. As soon as a call is received on the Help-line, the operator shall listen to the caller patiently by keeping in mind physical/mental condition of the caller and shall take all possible information about the grievance of the caller (i.e. type of problem/grievance, his/her present location, type of help/assistance he/she required etc.), including the details of the caller (whatever he/she discloses at that point of time without insisting too much on this aspect).
2. The same shall be immediately passed to the local police, nearest PCR Van, Ambulance etc. as well as other concerned authorities/agencies as per the requirement.
3. The operator will also assure the complainant/caller of quick action and shall encourage the caller to keep patience and not to lose his/her control/temper/composure.
4. After passing the information to all concerned, a brief note about the caller, mentioning the maximum details available i.e. name, age, sex, present location, type of grievances/complaint, as well as the name of the officer to whom the call has been passed/entrusted for further action shall be prepared.
5. The nearest PCR van shall reach the caller at the earliest (within journey time) and shall provide all possible assistance to the caller without waiting for local police and shall confirm their position at the spot.
6. The PCR Van shall suo-moto respond immediately to any incident which unfolds before them or reported to them or brought to their notice. Under no circumstances shall the PCR van remain as mere spectator to the incident.
7. I/C PCR van shall give the situation report at once to the Control Room.
8. The officer from the local police to whom the call has been marked/entrusted must reach the complainant/caller at the earliest without fail. Any delay on the part of the officer to whom the call has been marked will be viewed seriously.
9. The DO/IO should reach the caller with all the required/necessary equipment. Keeping the mental and physical condition of the caller in mind, maximum possible aid should be provided immediately.

10. SHO concerned shall also reach the spot at once and inform District Control Room about the situation (details of the incident).
11. An action taken report should be mentioned in the Daily Diary as well as the register being maintained for the Help-line Call Register with the Women Help Desk.

(E) SUPERVISOR'S ROLE:

1. To ensure that all calls are being attended promptly and call has been taken to its logical conclusion by the operator, as early, as possible.
2. To note down the shortcomings in call handling, if any, and direct the concerned operator for further corrective action with necessary guidance. He/she will also brief/de-brief all operators before start of the duty shift and at the time of closing of the duty shift.
3. To close the incident in case all the tasks have been properly completed.
4. To check all the closed calls and ensure that proper/needful action has been taken on each call.
5. Calls must be chosen at random and contacted to collect feedback to assess the quality of service of Women Helpline. For this, callers shall be contacted through mobile/landline telephone or/and any other available means.
6. The I/C of the Centralized Helpline Centre, after getting the confirmation about reaching of assistance to the caller will also confirm the same at his/her level.
7. He/she shall also confirm that the assistance/police help has reached/provided to the caller and also note down his/her comments/response.
8. If the caller is not satisfied, or the failure of reaching assistance to the caller is noticed by the I/C of the Centralized Helpline Centre, he/she shall immediately bring the facts into the notice of concerned DCP, ACP & SHO. A report about the failure to provide desired assistance shall also be furnished to the concerned Jt. CP on a daily basis.

(F) ANALYSIS & CORRECTIVE MEASURES:

1. A daily as well as fortnightly and monthly report with regard to the calls received and their disposal including the time of reaching the spot and action taken shall be submitted to the senior officers without fail.
2. On the basis of the complaints/calls received at the Helpline, Research Cell, PHQ will conduct an analysis on fortnightly basis and share with District Police so that preventive steps can be taken.
3. DCsP Districts/Units shall monitor all the calls forwarded to the District/Unit concerned and action taken in each such call. No call shall be kept pending without any cogent reason and that too only for a short time.
4. Failure to act swiftly on any such call/action taken will warrant strict disciplinary action against IO/SHO/ACP concerned.

This issues with the approval of C.P.

No 55 /Psec/SP/CP/OPS, dated 18/01/2013.

Copy to all concerned.

R
18/1/2013
SP/CP/OPS.